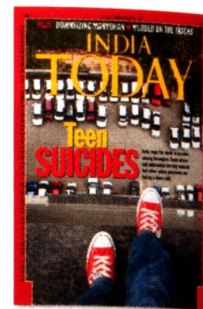
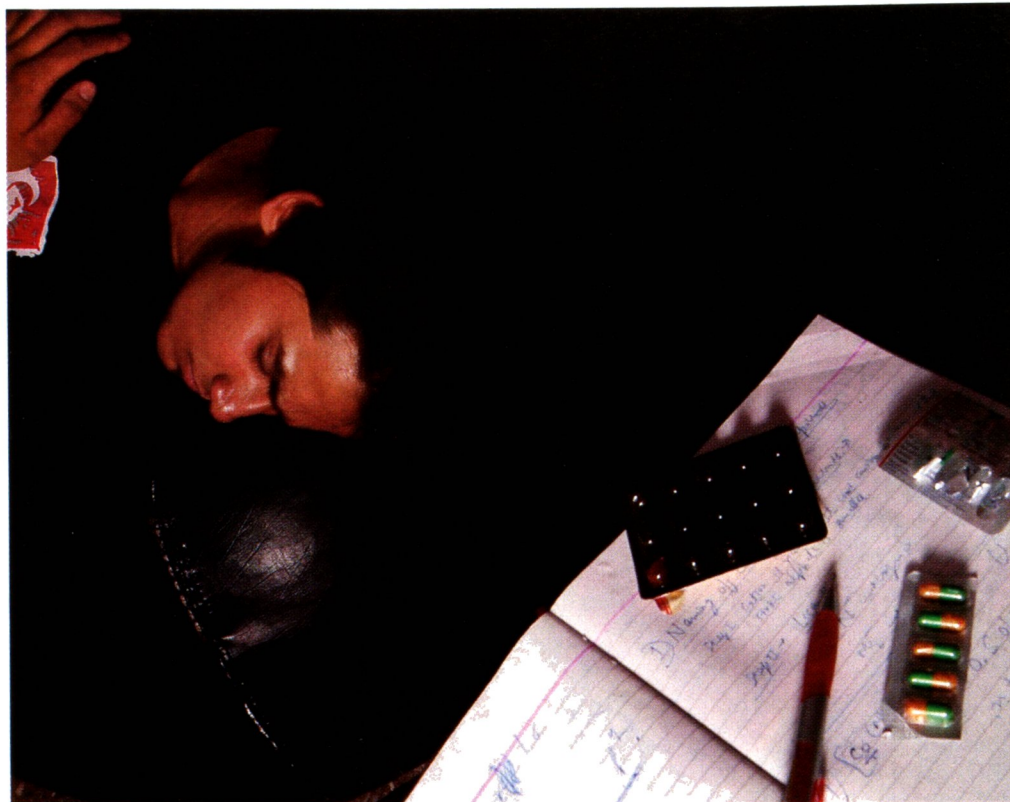


REUBEN SINGH



"Teen Suicides",
April 28, 2008

"Parents should remember that their children do not belong to them. Let us not break these arrows, on the pretext of sharpening them."

HEMLATA MORO, Mysore

Save Their Souls

Indubitably laudable, the article is, however, long on enumerating the causes but rather terse in advising the remedies ("Teen Suicides", April 28). It should have emphasised the importance of paying keen attention to behavioural warning signals from a suicide-prone child to prevent the tragedy. Parents need to educate themselves about this.

Y.G.CHOUKSEY, Pune

Teen suicides are on a rise because parents try to fulfil their dreams through their children.

MADHU R.D. SINGH, Ambala

Growing suicidal tendencies among teenagers are the effects of the dark side of socio-economic advancement. Before expecting anything big, parents should make a fair judgement of their children's skills.

INDU SHANKAR, Varanasi

The cover story was extremely disturbing. Parents should not pamper their children to such an extent that they are unable to face the disappointments that life inevitably holds.

RANJANA MANCHANDA,
on e-mail

It is high time that the country's educational system was revamped so that studies became a source of pleasure for the kids, and not a burden as they are today.

A. JACOB SAHAYAM,
Thiruvananthapuram

If only the elders of a family took time out from their race for money to teach the GenNext some human values, several young lives would be saved.

VLJAYA BHARATI, on e-mail

With the changing social scenario, wherein the joint family system of yore has given way to nuclear families with both parents busy

juggling home and hearth with their careers, teenagers today do not have a support system to fall back on. This is what results in such drastic steps.

NALINI VIJAYARAGHAVAN,
Thiruvananthapuram

Even before I had opened the magazine, I knew that a huge chunk of the story would be dedicated to the education system of the country. It has been the same old story that gets repeated year after year—the fate of a large portion of young India is locked up in tragic numbers.

The magazine should come up with stories that provide ways to solve the age-old problem.

MEGHA GUPTA, on e-mail

The article needs more research as it has not focused much on the problems that meritorious students face in getting admissions to colleges and institutes of repute on

account of the government's reservation policy.

S. SRINIVASAN, on e-mail

Sizing Him Up

As long as Manmohan Singh enjoys Sonia Gandhi's trust and confidence, there is no question of his being downsized ("Downsizing Manmohan", April 28). Rahul Gandhi will some day assume more responsibility, but projecting him as the country's next prime minister is premature.

D.B.N. MURTHY, Bangalore

Manmohan Singh is being downsized right from the day he became the country's prime minister. The snub that Arjun Singh—a family faithful—got for projecting Rahul as the next prime minister, should be a lesson for other Congressmen to stop being sycophants and have some self-respect.

A. SRIKANTIAH, Bangalore